In upholding these arguments, Orbán and his party often invoked their alleged ideological arch-enemy, Mr Soros, even to the point of recourse to antisemitism, further adding to the parallels to pre-World War II Europe and the advent of Fascism at the time. Soros' support to various NGOs, promoting liberal values and the cause of migrants often, though not initially (at one point even a young Mr Orbán was the recipient), run contrary to the socially conservative policies of Mr Orbán and his ilk. What was certainly not helpful to Soros was his background in speculative finance operations. Even Soros himself 'expressed doubts about the social and economic impact of the globalised financial markets, in which he made his fortune.'[150] And Emily Tamkin, the author of *The Influence of Soros*, admits that there has been a 'tension between Soros' financial abilities and his philanthropic ambitions'[151] and concludes that in that respect 'Soros is at best paradoxical and at worst hypocritical'.[152] To what extent his grand and commendable philanthropic work is compromised thus remains to be analysed. But what is more important is to ask whether the liberal agenda, as pursued by Soros and the NGOs financed by him, is in its entirety and as a whole something that best represents the agreed set of European values, something that must be upheld at all costs. And, at the same time, is social conservatism, as seen in Eastern Europe, already a definite departure from Western liberalism? In what areas or in what way? Was it really unavoidable – on both sides – to arrive at a situation in which Soros' efforts are met with such strong opposition, precisely there, where they are most needed? At the same time, conservatives in Central Europe should ask themselves whether Mr Orbán and Mr Kaczyński are also the best placed and most legitimate representatives of the views of Central and Eastern Europe, even of its conservative cohort. Also, could – and under what circumstances – Muslim migrants in the 2015/2016 crisis have received a better welcome by Eastern Europe, as they should, given the region's professed Christian values?

These are questions which are – notwithstanding Orbán's clever utilisation of his compatriots' hearts and minds – rarely being asked and even more rarely answered. It is much easier to simply reject the opposition to Soros' agenda as an unacceptably conservative social engineering or a right-wing extremism; even Fascism is a word used here and there. But neo-Marxists, post-modern neo-liberals, Putin in the case of Ukraine and Stalin at the time